# Earl Hickson Jr.

## HCI Graduate Applicant | Lead Front-End Engineer

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## APPLICANT SUMMARY

Front-end engineer and independent HCI practitioner with a background in graphic design, frontend engineering, and full-stack product development. My work explores how interactive systems can strengthen human capability across relationships, learning, privacy, and complex decision-making without unnecessarily replacing human agency.

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human-computer interaction | Learning technologies | Privacy and consent | Decision support | Information architecture | Accessibility | Human agency and automation

## EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

**Bachelor of Fine Arts in Graphic Design** | Kean University, Union, New Jersey | 2015

**IBM Full Stack Software Developer Professional Certificate** | IBM / Coursera | December 2025 | Verify

**Full Stack JavaScript Certificate** | Team Treehouse | 2022

**Front-End Web Development Certificate** | Team Treehouse | 2022

## SELECTED INDEPENDENT HCI INVESTIGATIONS

### WithYou | Independent HCI investigation

How should shared technology support connection without assuming unrestricted access?

Contribution: Solo product design, UX engineering, and full-stack development. Evidence boundary: Legacy profile visibility is per account, not per relationship space.

ehicksonjr.com/work/withyou

### Gundam Forge | Independent HCI investigation

How can interfaces help people navigate complexity without making the decision for them?

Contribution: Solo product design and full-stack product development. Evidence boundary: Official competitive ban/restriction coverage is incomplete.

ehicksonjr.com/work/gundam-forge

### DojoNet | Independent HCI investigation

How can digital systems support progression without reducing learning to completion?

Contribution: Solo product design and frontend product development. Evidence boundary: Instructor workflows require further design and implementation verification.

ehicksonjr.com/work/dojonet

## TECHNICAL PREPARATION

**Production (employer and client work):** JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, SCSS/Sass, React, Vue.js, Bootstrap 3-5, REST APIs (GET/POST, JSON), Responsive and mobile-first UI, WCAG 2.1 AA, Cross-browser QA, Git, Bitbucket, CI/CD pipelines, .NET-hosted front ends, WordPress (custom PHP plugins), Wix CMS, Responsive HTML email

**Shipped in independent products:** TypeScript, Next.js (App Router, static export), Tailwind CSS, Vitest, React Testing Library, Zod, TanStack Query, Radix UI, Zustand, Node.js, Express, Prisma, PostgreSQL, Supabase, React Native (Expo), Socket.IO, GitHub Actions, Playwright, Vite

**Design and UX:** Figma, Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign), Design tokens and component standards, Information architecture, Interaction design, Design-to-code handoff

**Measurement and platforms:** Google Analytics, Hotjar, Lighthouse, SEO, HubSpot, Salesforce Marketing Cloud, Zen Planner API

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### Front-End Developer & Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu Professor | AMA Fight Club

Cedar Knolls, NJ | Jan 2025 - Present

Own the gym's website end to end, including a Zen Planner API integration that syncs web leads to the membership CRM, and lead its Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu program.

### Independent Front-End Developer | Freelance and Contract

Remote | Nov 2024 - Oct 2025

A custom WordPress donation-campaign plugin for Tabby's Place, and React and TypeScript dashboard screens for Wealth Creation Innovation.

### Front-End Developer | Asembia

Florham Park, NJ | Dec 2023 - Oct 2024

Set one component and brand-token standard across HIPAA-regulated patient, provider, and prescriber portals, led the Bootstrap 3 to 5 migration, and got the team building to it.

### Lead Designer & Front-End Developer | BroadcastMed / Conexiant

Remote | Aug 2021 - Feb 2023

Led design and front-end delivery of healthcare marketing microsites, raised lead-form submissions 18%, and built an email system that cut production time 25%.

### Front-End Developer, Contract | Prosek Partners

Remote | Apr 2021 - Sep 2021

Responsive landing pages and campaign interfaces in React, plus client projects in Vue.js.

### Front-End Developer, Contract | William R. Seide Agency LLC

New Jersey | Jan 2020 - Jun 2020

Mobile-first sites for insurance and financial-services clients.

### Email Marketing Specialist, Contract | Merkle

Remote | Nov 2018 - Jul 2019

Responsive HTML email for pharmaceutical campaigns, tested across email clients.

Earlier: front-end and digital design roles at Kirshenbaum Bond Senecal + Partners and Second Melody, 2013-2017.

## COACHING AND LEADERSHIP

A Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu black belt, teaching youth and adult students since 2021. That coaching carries straight into mentoring engineers: progressive instruction, close observation, honest feedback, and adapting to how each person learns.

**AMA Fight Club** | Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu Professor | Cedar Knolls, NJ | 2025 - Present

**Colton Brown Training Center** | Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu Instructor | Warren, NJ | 2023 - 2024

**Pure MMA** | Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu Instructor | Rockaway, NJ | 2021 - 2022

## RESEARCH PREPARATION

**Methods used:** Analytics review | Hotjar-informed evaluation | Accessibility auditing | Interaction prototyping | Design-system evaluation | Implementation analysis | Technical usability review

**Methods sought through graduate study:** Semi-structured interviews | Usability testing | Diary studies | Contextual inquiry | Observation | Qualitative coding | Experimental design | Mixed methods | Research ethics

## SELECTED WRITING

Teaching Jiu-Jitsu Changed the Way I Think About UX | Learning | July 14, 2026

Designing Consent Into Digital Products | Relationships | July 14, 2026

What Trading Card Games Teach Us About Information Architecture | Decision Support | July 14, 2026